

A Brilliant \$1 Billion Shopify Niche Store

Channel: Arie Scherson · Published: Aug 26, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J8-qWxUiMtY> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Biodance, a Korean collagen mask brand with \$250–300M in sales, built its empire through Amazon, TikTok live selling, and retail — not a polished Shopify store — revealing powerful multi-channel lessons for any e-commerce brand builder.

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Introduction & Arie's Credentials [0:00](#)

- Arie frames the video as a full dissection of Biodance: marketing channels, Shopify store, niche, and expansion
- His lens: running an agency on Meta at the **highest-tier "batched" agency partner status** with over **\$10 million in managed ad spend**
- Also building his own brand, currently at **\$3 million/year** and growing fast, with a personal goal of reaching \$1 billion
 - Studies fast-growing brands to compound ideas over 5–6 years of research
 - Notes that with AI now handling execution, original ideas and research matter more than ever

What Is Biodance? [0:29](#)

- Biodance is a Korean beauty brand best known for its **collagen bio-cellulose masks**

- Has sold between **250 and 300 million units** of the mask — a staggering volume for a single SKU
- Frequently ripped/copied by dropshippers, but Arie emphasizes the original brand always wins more
 - "You never make as much by ripping people"
 - With AI tools now available, there's no excuse not to build an original, unique brand
- The product itself is the primary driver — market demand outweighs store/design quality

Distribution Strategy: Amazon & Retail Over Shopify 1:22

- Shopify store gets roughly **300,000 monthly visitors** (~4,000 at time of recording, noted as off-peak season)
 - Arie flags this as surprisingly low for a brand of this scale
- The real distribution engine is **Amazon + physical retail**, not DTC Shopify
- On Amazon, Biodance "absolutely crushes it"
 - Key takeaway: Amazon is still massively underutilized ("slept on") as a channel
 - Even die-hard Shopify advocates (like Arie) should now run both simultaneously
 - Consumers will always default to Amazon for many purchases — ignoring it is leaving money on the table
 - Some of their paid ads actually drive traffic directly to their **Amazon listing**, not their Shopify store
 - A deliberate strategy to dominate Amazon rankings and leverage its logistics infrastructure
- Arie calls Amazon's logistics network "the most advanced in the world" and personally views Amazon stock as a strong investment for this reason

South Korea & Global Expansion 2:17

- Major retail presence in **Olive Young** — a South Korean health/beauty retailer with **1,300 physical stores**
 - Biodance ranks **#1** in that channel
- Also available in **Sephora** and similar premium beauty retailers
- South Korea flagged as an underrated market: "So many billion-dollar e-commerce companies are coming out of that market"
- Biodance is doing live selling globally in **every language** — a direct signal of their global-first mindset
- Arie says this inspires his own goal to expand his brand globally and "pull every lever" possible

Shopify Store Critique 2:41

- Landing page is described as "extremely simple" — Arie likes the overall simplicity
- The **buy box** is called out as "really amateurish" — doesn't communicate a strong offer or urgency
- Despite this, they are **sold out** of the product — further proof that product-market fit and marketing trump store design
 - "The product itself matters more than literally anything. And then of course, marketing and offers."

- Key lesson: don't over-invest in design if your product demand is strong — but also, a better buy box could only help

Paid Ads Analysis 3:35

- Running approximately **390 different ads** at time of analysis
 - By contrast, some hyper-scaling brands Arie knows run **5,000 active ads simultaneously**
 - Biodance's approach shows you don't need massive ad volume — being intentional works
- Many top ads drive users to Amazon (not Shopify) — reinforcing their Amazon-first strategy
- Lots of **UGC (user-generated content) style videos** in the ad mix
- Top ads sorted by highest impressions are described as highly replicable
 - Arie notes ChatGPT's image generation is currently best-in-class and extremely cheap
 - "You have like an elite graphic designer at your disposal"
- Arie plans to personally recreate one of Biodance's top-performing post formats for his own brand immediately after filming

Search Volume & Trend Data (PlutoHunt) 5:17

- Data pulled from **PlutoHunt** (plutohunt.com) — Arie's own platform, previously called Shoppilab
 - Rebranded because Shoppilab was too Shopify-specific; PlutoHunt now covers TikTok Shop and more
 - Aggregates data from SimilarWeb, Caliou, and similar sources in one cheaper, cleaner interface
- Biodance brand search traffic is **"absolutely blowing up"** and accelerating
- Specific trend highlight:
 - **"Dark spot mask"** search term has seen a **+2,900% increase** in demand
 - Signals a hot emerging sub-niche within the mask category
 - Arie recommends using this as a starting lightbulb moment, then going deeper with ChatGPT to explore the opportunity

The Other "Biodance" — Spiritual Well-Being Opportunity 7:01

- "Biodance" also refers to a **self-development system** using music, movement, and interaction to improve emotional, physical, and spiritual well-being
 - Originated in the **1960s** — not a new concept, but currently in early digital-era relevance
- The Biodance brand's search volume spike is primarily driven by the beauty brand, but this parallel meaning is an untapped opportunity
- Arie believes the wellness/movement angle has massive modern relevance
 - "Anything where you utilize movement, music, and improve emotional, physical, and spiritual well-being — I feel like right now is what people need"
- Suggested opportunity: build a **digital product or app** around Biodance as a self-development method

TikTok & Social Media Strategy 7:51

- TikTok is one of their **primary demand-generation channels**, especially in the US
- **Live selling every single day** — multiple streams, in multiple languages for global reach
 - PlutoHunt has a live stream search feature to find other brands doing this
- Strong follower count and engaged audience across platforms
- Content quality is high; their aesthetic is consistent and aspirational
- One notable post with **1,700 likes** was identified as easy to recreate — and turned out to be **AI-generated**
 - The post explicitly notes it "features an AI-generated fictional character"
 - A brand at this scale is openly using AI imagery — Arie sees this as a green light for all brands to do the same
 - "I think right now is really the best time to be building"

Ad Comment Analysis & Missed Opportunities 9:09

- Tool used: **Facebook Ad Comment Analysis by Smart Reply** (free tool)
- Biodance scores an **"F" grade** — meaning they respond to almost **none** of their comments
 - A major missed opportunity for customer engagement and conversion
- Key negative/critical comments surfaced by the tool:
 - Some viewers find the ad's presenter style off-putting ("they think it's ugly when a man speaks like a woman")
 - **Product experience objection**: "I tried the masks and they don't actually turn into water, they just stay as they are and make a mess"
 - Actionable fix: address this upfront in ads or email marketing — set expectations clearly so it doesn't feel like a bad experience
 - **Demographic gap**: "Honey, you're so young. Why do you even need this stuff?"
 - Signals they're missing **older demographics** who would likely resonate strongly with the product
 - Arie notes they do target older audiences somewhat, but could do significantly more in the US
- Positive and neutral comments also abundant — people asking questions that go unanswered
 - "There's no excuse these days to not respond to literally every single comment"
 - Smart Reply automates responses trained on your brand voice — responds instantly to everything

The biggest missed opportunity for Biodance isn't their simple store or their ad count — it's ignoring their comments. Every unanswered question is a lost sale.

AI-Generated Content in Action 11:02

- Confirmed: Biodance is using **AI-generated images and videos** in their social content at scale

- One viral-performing post was explicitly labeled as featuring an AI fictional character
- Arie's reaction: if a company at this caliber is doing it, it validates AI content for everyone
- He plans to immediately apply what he learned — recreating Biodance's top post format for his own brand
 - "Clearly it's working well. It's not really my demographic, but still you can always be smart and adapt things as you need."

Akemi Community & PlutoHunt Announcement [11:48](#)

- Arie has launched a **School community called Akemi** under his agency studio
 - Includes courses and access to a Discord community
 - Previously, Shoppilab hosted both course content AND research software — found to be too confusing
 - Split into two separate products: Akemi (community/courses) and PlutoHunt (research software)
- Described as "extremely affordable for the value" with a money-back guarantee if unsatisfied
- Still in soft launch / active development — more details promised in future videos